

# Department of Software Engineering

## Daffodil International University

### Tense • ENGLISH I

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#### □ Tense:

- ☑ Generally, the word “tense” means any of the forms of a verb which show the time at which an action happened. However, tense can be defined as the form of verb which is used to indicate the time of occurrence of an incident concerning the moment of speaking. It indicates the completion or continuance of an activity.
- ☑ In other words, tenses are changes or additions to verbs to show when the action took place: in the past, present, or future. The term “tense” is also used for grammatical aspects, which add more details about the duration or time an action takes. When we combine the grammatical aspects with the past, present and future, we end up with twelve main *verb tenses* in English.
- ☑ There are also additional aspects that give extra details, such as the length of time the action occurred, which actions happened first, or whether a past action has an impact on the present. These grammatical aspects are the simple tense, perfect tense, continuous tense, and perfect continuous tense.

#### □ How many tenses are there in English?

- ❖ The standard tense in English is the **present tense**, which is usually just the root form of the verb. The **past** and **future** tenses often require changes or additions to the root form, such as the suffix – **ed** for the past tense and the modal verb **will** for the future.
- ❖ However, for each of the past, present, and future tenses, there are **four different aspects** that add additional details. For example, the continuous tense shows that an action is ongoing. It can be used in the present (she is sleeping), past (she was sleeping), or future (she will be sleeping).

❖ So, the twelve main tenses are –

**1. Past Tense**

- i. Simple Past Tense
- ii. Past Continuous Tense
- iii. Past Perfect Tense
- iv. Past Perfect Continuous Tense

**2. Present Tense**

- i. Simple Present Tense
- ii. Present Continuous Tense
- iii. Present Perfect Tense
- iv. Present Perfect Continuous Tense

**3. Future Tense**

- i. Simple Future Tense
- ii. Future Continuous Tense
- iii. Future Perfect Tense
- iv. Future Perfect Continuous Tense

## ❑ Tenses Rules Chart:

❖ Understanding the rules of tenses is essential to avoid grammatical errors and indicate the timing of events or actions in a sentence. To memorize and understand the rules better, here is a tabulated representation –

| Tenses                                  | Tense Rules                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Past Simple Tense</b>                | Subject + V <sub>2</sub> + Object                                                                                                               |
| <b>Past Continuous Tense</b>            | Subject + was + V <sub>1</sub> + ing + Object ( <b>Singular</b> )<br>Subject + were + V <sub>1</sub> + ing + Object ( <b>Plural</b> )           |
| <b>Past Perfect Tense</b>               | Subject + had + V <sub>3</sub> + Object                                                                                                         |
| <b>Past Perfect Continuous Tense</b>    | Subject + had been + V <sub>1</sub> + ing + Object                                                                                              |
| <b>Present Simple Tense</b>             | Subject + V <sub>1</sub> + s/es + Object ( <b>Third Person Singular</b> )<br>Subject + V <sub>1</sub> + Object                                  |
| <b>Present Continuous Tense</b>         | Subject + is/am/are + V <sub>1</sub> + ing + object                                                                                             |
| <b>Present Perfect Tense</b>            | Subject + has + V <sub>3</sub> + Object ( <b>Singular</b> )<br>Subject + have + V <sub>3</sub> + Object ( <b>Plural</b> )                       |
| <b>Present Perfect Continuous Tense</b> | Subject + has been + V <sub>1</sub> + ing + Object ( <b>Singular</b> )<br>Subject + have been + V <sub>1</sub> + ing + Object ( <b>Plural</b> ) |
| <b>Future Simple Tense</b>              | Subject + will/shall + V <sub>1</sub> + Object                                                                                                  |
| <b>Future Continuous Tense</b>          | Subject + will be/shall be + V <sub>1</sub> + ing + Object                                                                                      |
| <b>Future Perfect Tense</b>             | Subject + will have/shall have + V <sub>3</sub> + Object                                                                                        |
| <b>Future Perfect Continuous Tense</b>  | Subject + will have been + V <sub>1</sub> + ing + Object                                                                                        |

- ★ V<sub>1</sub> = first form of the verb (base/main form)
- ★ V<sub>2</sub> = second form of the verb (past form)
- ★ V<sub>3</sub> = third form of the verb (past participle form)

## □ Types of Tense:

- ❖ There are basic three types of tenses –
  1. Past Tense
  2. Present Tense
  3. Future Tense
- ❖ These tenses can further be categorized into four types:
  - i. Simple Tense/Indefinite Tense
  - ii. Continuous Tense
  - iii. Perfect Tense
  - iv. Perfect Continuous Tense

We will now discuss each category with the rule and their examples.

### 1. Past Tense:

#### i. Simple Past Tense/Past Indefinite Tense –

We use the simple past to show actions completed in the past, with no extra emphasis.

For **regular verbs**, you form the simple past tense by adding the suffix *-ed* to the end of the verb (or just *-d* if the past tense verb already ends in an “e”).

Be careful of **irregular past tense verbs**, however. These don’t follow the normal rules and use their own unique forms for the past tense. For example, the past tense of the irregular verb “go” is “went”.

Example:

*Regular verbs:* I **picked** up the glass, but it **dropped** from my hand.

*Irregular verbs:* This morning I **went** to the store, but I **forgot** to buy eggs.

#### ii. Past Continuous Tense –

Use the past continuous to show an ongoing action in the past, especially if the action was interrupted by another action. It’s also used for habitual actions that occurred in the past but not in the present. It’s usually used with adverbs like “always” or adverb phrases like “all the time”.

Example:

My dog **was whimpering** in his sleep when the TV woke him up.

As kids, my friends and I **were** always **getting** into trouble.

#### iii. Past Perfect Tense –

What if you’re talking about two different actions in the past and want to show

that one happened before the other? The past perfect, also known as the *pluperfect*, shows that one past action happened earlier than another one.

Example:

She **had arrived** at the classroom before the class started.

I ran to my car when I noticed my wife **had left** already.

#### iv. **Past Perfect Continuous Tense –**

The past perfect continuous tense is used just like the past perfect tense, except it describes ongoing actions that happened in the past instead of a one-time occurrence. It's often used with the words *when*, *until*, and *before* to connect it to another past action.

Example:

Before he got his first job as a writer, he **had been working** as a proofreader.

I **had been living** on my friend's couch for a year until they kicked me out.

## 2. **Present Tense:**

### i. **Present Simple Tense/Present Indefinite Tense –**

The simple present is the most basic of the English tenses. It's used for individual actions, universal truth, or habitual actions in the present.

Often the simple present is just the root verb with no changes or additions. The main **exception** to this is when the **subject is third person and singular**. In this case we add the suffix *-s*. If the verb ends in **o, ch, sh, th, ss, gh, or z**, we add *-es*. If the verb ends in a **consonant** and **y** (and *the subject is third-person singular*), drop the y and add *-ies*.

Example:

Today I **feel** like a million bucks!

My brother **carries** the groceries while my sister stays on the couch.

The goalie **focuses** on the football so that he **does not miss** the ball.

### ii. **Present Continuous Tense –**

Use the present continuous to show an action happening right now or in the near future.

Example:

I **am reading** Feluda series for the fifth time!

We **are eating** pizza tonight.

### iii. **Present Perfect Tense –**

Although it's quite common, the present perfect is one of the most difficult English verb tenses. It is used to describe a few different types of actions, including:

- *an ongoing action started in the past that is not yet completed*
- *the same action completed multiple times in the past and likely to be completed again*

- *an action completed very recently (usually with just or now)*
- *an uncompleted action that is expected to be finished (in the negative)*

Additionally, the present perfect can be used to emphasize the significance of a completed action, especially one that happened over time.

Example:

We **have tricked** him every April Fool's Day since we were kids.

I **have finished** making the presentation.

My niece **has grown** so much this year!

#### iv. **Present Perfect Continuous Tense –**

The present perfect continuous shows an ongoing action in the present that was started in the past. It is often used to emphasize the length of time.

Example:

We **have been waiting** for over an hour!

The team **has been practicing** nonstop for the tournament.

### 3. **Future Tense:**

#### i. **Future Simple Tense/Future Indefinite Tense –**

Use the simple future for actions that have not happened yet but will in the future. To form the simple future, just place the modal verb “**will**” before the root form of the main verb.

**NB: Note that if the action will happen in the near future, you can use the present continuous instead.**

Example:

I **will be** successful one day.

She **will not go** to the party without a date!

#### ii. **Future Continuous Tense –**

Use the future continuous tense for future actions happening over a period of time, especially when a specific time is mentioned. The future continuous tense also shows more certainty and likelihood than the simple future.

Example:

By this time tomorrow, I **will be relaxing** on the beach.

We **will be attending** a meeting from noon until 3 p.m.

#### iii. **Future Perfect Tense –**

The future perfect shows an action that will be completed in the future by a specified time. Because it depends on another time, the future perfect is often used with words like *by, before, at, or when*.

Example:

By the time you read this, I **will have left** the country.

She **will have eaten** lunch before her sister even wakes up.

iv. **Future Perfect Continuous Tense –**

The future perfect continuous depicts future ongoing actions that continue up until a certain point. Like the future perfect and future continuous, it's used with a specified time.

Example:

In ten minutes, my parents **will have been waiting** in traffic for four hours.

I **will have been eating** healthy for a whole year by September.

**NOW CHILLAX! 😊**